

BSc General Computing Science

1. CHECK YOUR “ACADEMIC REQUIREMENTS” REPORT (AAR) IN BEARTRACKS

This is located in your “*Manage Classes*” icon in BearTracks, with the Academic Requirements Report link on the left hand side

- This report is a digital version of your degree requirements so you can track your progress against the requirements of your degree in real time
- Provides critical alerts for you to be aware of before you take the courses for credit
- Checks to make sure you are meeting all the requirements of your degree and easily shows you what elements of your degree that you are still missing

2. ENSURE YOU’VE COMPLETED YOUR JUNIOR CORE REQUIREMENTS:

- View available courses on our [BSc General Degree Requirements Planning Sheet](#)
 - *6 English
 - *6 Mathematical Sciences
 - *6 Physical Sciences
 - *6 Laboratory Sciences

3. LOOKING TO YOUR COMPUTING SCIENCE MAJOR

- You need a minimum of ***36 credits** to complete this major
- CMPUT 174 and CMPUT 175 should be taken in the first year (which is part of your *6 in Mathematical Sciences for the Junior Core requirements)
 - If CMPUT 101 is taken prior to CMPUT 174 then it may be used under the *12 CMPUT requirement.
- *6 in CMPUT 201, 204, 229, 272, or 291 should be taken in the second year.
 - These courses act as a prerequisite for senior level CMPUT courses
 - Make sure to check prerequisites requirements, including MATH courses, for senior level CMPUT courses in advance so you can take the proper courses in your second and third years.
 - If you take more than *6 from this list, these courses can now be used towards the ***12 CMPUT options** requirement
- The ***3 CMPUT 4XX** requirement and ***9 CMPUT at 300+** requirement are separate requirements and **cannot be combined**
- CMPUT courses should be taken at the UofA and not at a visiting institution. The CMPUT courses are set up to ensure you have the prerequisite knowledge to be successful in higher level CMPUT courses.

4. LOOK TO YOUR MINOR OR DOUBLE MAJOR

- Another aspect of your degree is the **mandatory** second area of study
- You can pick a minor from *Faculty of Science, Arts, Agriculture Life and Environmental Sciences (ALES)*, or *Business* or pick a double major from the *Faculty of Science*
 - *Business* minors require a new application and a set of prerequisite courses to be completed before being eligible
 - You can't have the same minor or double major as your initial major
- If you haven't declared your minor or double major you can do so on the [SciForms web portal](#)
- All possible options for a minor or double major can be viewed on our [BSc General Degree Requirements Planning Sheet](#)

5. OPTIONS/ELECTIVES IN MY DEGREE

- Exact credit minimums and maximums are listed in the [BSc General Degree Requirement PDF](#)
- [Arts options](#) (*any courses offered by the Faculty of Arts*)
- [Science options](#) (*any courses offered by the Faculty of Science*)
- Outside options (*any courses not offered by the Faculty of Arts or Science*)

6. TALK TO YOUR ACADEMIC ADVISOR

If you still have questions or concerns after reviewing all of this material you should contact your Academic [Advisor](#).

ADDITIONAL TIPS

Create a balanced timetable: Do not register for more than two or three lab based courses per term as you will have lab assignments and exams in addition to regular course work.

Only register in courses for which you have the prerequisite: Students without the appropriate prerequisites will be removed from the course or credit will be withheld. Make sure to read the course description before you register in a course on Bear Tracks as Bear Tracks may not prevent you from registering in a course you don't have the prerequisite for.

The class you want is full: If a class is full simply place the class on your watch list ([found on BearTracks](#)). You can also speak with the teaching department in charge of that class to see if anything else can be done or to see if a new section could be available.

Familiarize yourself with all courses. You can use the Course Listings in the U of A Calendar to search courses by prefix so that you can get an overview of course content, and prerequisites for courses offered at the U of A. Keep in mind that you will still need to check Bear Tracks to ensure the course is being offered.

Try something new. Your degree requirements are not just about fulfilling your major and minor. Why not try a course in an area you have always been interested in? Or, perhaps build some hands on experience into your degree by taking a research course. You can try entering a hobby or interest into the "Keyword or Phrase" search box in the Course Filter under Course Listings. For example, "sustainability". Leave all other search boxes as is. This will list all of the UofA courses which involve the topic of sustainability. screenshot?

Watch out for 100-level courses. All Faculty of Science degrees allow for a maximum of *42 at the 100-level, this includes junior core requirements. Know how many you have before registering in options courses. If you have reached the *42 maximum 100-level option courses may not count towards your degree.